

Project Close-Out Report

Project Close-Out Report	
Report Date: 15 November 20xx	
KEY INFORMATION	
Project Name	AHI Real-Time Marketing Data App (AHI App Development)
Division/Department	Marketing & Information Technology
Project Sponsor	Mary Smithers
Project Manager	Cary Manning

PROJECT GOALS
1. Provide customers with easier, direct access to view AHI skincare products and clear pricing.
2. Enable secure customer transaction processing, automated invoicing, and order status tracking.
3. Track real-time market trends across the skincare industry to identify emerging segments and demographics.
4. Monitor customer preferences, opinion analysis, and brand sentiment to support concept testing.
5. Analyze global competitive sales data and calculate AHI market share trends by product category.

PROJECT GOAL SUCCESS ANALYSIS
1. Success: Fully accomplished. Positive customer focus group feedback confirmed smooth product browsing and clear, transparent pricing.
2. Success: Fully accomplished. Implemented robust payment encryption, automatic invoice generation, and reliable order tracking.
3. Partial Success: Core trend visualization was built, but two external industry data feeds were omitted due to requirements gathering gaps and deferred to Version 2.
4. Partial Success: Customer review collection and sentiment dashboards are operational, but several custom leadership reports were not completed and moved to Version 2.
5. Partial Success: AHI category market share calculation formula was successfully implemented, but full external competitive data integration was postponed to Version 2.

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SCOPE REVIEW

- **Variances Encountered:** The finished App does not include 100% of the originally intended features. Specifically, two required third-party data feeds and several leadership intelligence reports were omitted from Version 1.
- **Why They Happened:** Inadequate requirements gathering during initial kickoff resulted in key user needs being overlooked in early user stories. This led to multiple mid-project change requests and scope tradeoffs during development.
- **Future Prevention:** Conduct disciplined, cross-functional requirements workshops with marketing, executive leadership, and IT before sprint planning begins. Implement structured Product Backlog refinement to capture technical feed specifications early.

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SCHEDULE REVIEW

- Variances Encountered: Development fell behind the original two-sprint schedule. The team successfully recovered and completed the core App within the 90-day development window by adding a third sprint. Minor interface fixes remain with a forecasted IT closeout date of 15 November.
- Why They Happened: Team velocity was estimated based on subjective assumptions rather than measured data. Furthermore, developers mixed predictive waterfall and adaptive agile methods, creating process confusion.
- Future Prevention: Conduct formal Scrum training for the team prior to project kickoff. Measure sprint velocity strictly using empirical story points rather than assumptions to build realistic sprint schedules.

COST REVIEW

- Variances Encountered: The project incurred an overall cost overrun of US \$7,000 above the original \$250,000 budget baseline (total actual cost: \$257,000).
- Why They Happened: Initial cost estimates were flawed. Hardware budgeting miscalculated storage needs, omitted necessary interface equipment items (\$2,000), and failed to include an inflation factor for external licensing and procurement.
- Future Prevention: Include detailed IT technical architecture reviews in initial cost estimating, validate equipment specs with vendor leads, and establish explicit inflation contingency reserves.

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RISK ANALYSIS

- Key Risks That Impacted the Project:
 1. Inadequate Requirements & Scope Omissions (Anticipated/Underestimated): Missing requirements caused scope volatility and deferred reporting features to Version 2.
 2. IT Staffing Vacancies (Unanticipated): IT struggled to find qualified personnel, hiring only 1 of 2 approved positions, which strained technical bandwidth.
 3. Cost Omissions & Inflation (Unanticipated): Interface equipment (\$2,000) and inflationary factors caused a \$7,000 budget overrun.
 4. Team Health / Flu Season (Anticipated): Seasonal illness threatened team availability during peak sprints, requiring careful workload balancing.
- Future Prevention & Risk Register Reference:

Conduct active bi-weekly Risk Register reviews, establish early talent acquisition pipelines with HR, and incorporate buffer contingencies for technical hardware dependencies. Refer to the formal AHI Project Risk Register on the PMO portal for detailed risk scoring and mitigation logs.

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OUTSTANDING ITEMS		
Issue	Planned Resolution	Assigned To
Minor App interface issues	Complete final UI interface bug fixes and testing by 15 November.	Priya Service (IT Lead) / Dev Team
Second IT staff vacancy unfilled	Continue recruiting with Human Relations; onboard second hire by 1 December.	Priya Service / HR Team
Deferred scope items (2 data feeds & leadership reports)	Document detailed specifications and prioritize into Product Backlog for App Version 2 release.	Cal Hamer (Product Owner)

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LESSONS LEARNED	
ITEM	NOTES
Customer-Facing Core Deliverables	Customer focus group feedback was overwhelmingly positive regarding product catalog access, clear pricing, and secure invoicing. Replicate by maintaining direct user-centric design principles.
Early Defect Elimination	Jose Garcia proactively identified and corrected a major flaw in the customer-facing UI before development finalized. Replicate by fostering team-wide peer reviews during sprint builds.
Schedule Recovery Agility	Adding Sprint 3 enabled the team to deliver all core functionality within the 90-day development window. Replicate by maintaining adaptive sprint buffer options.
DO BETTER	
ITEM	NOTES
Initial Requirements Scoping	Inadequate initial requirements gathering led to omitted data feeds and reporting features, causing scope churn. Avoid by conducting formal requirements workshops before kickoff.
Cost & Inflation Estimation	Budgeting missed \$2,000 in interface equipment and overlooked inflation, causing a \$7,000 overrun. Avoid by including IT engineering validation and contingency allowances.
Scrum Methodology Alignment	Team blended predictive and agile methods without formal Scrum training. Avoid by providing mandatory Scrum training before Sprint 1.
Technical Staff Recruitment	IT faced recruitment delays, leaving 1 approved position vacant. Avoid by initiating hiring pipelines earlier in project planning.
Velocity Estimation Approach	Velocity was based on subjective guesses rather than empirical data. Avoid by measuring team capacity using story points across sprints.

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RECOMMENDATIONS

1. Mandate formal Scrum training for cross-functional teams prior to Sprint 1 to ensure standard agile ceremonies and artifact usage.
2. Base sprint velocity on empirical story point sizing rather than subjective hour assumptions.
3. Implement rigorous requirements elicitation workshops with both business and technical stakeholders to eliminate omitted scope.
4. Involve IT systems architects during early budgeting to properly capture interface hardware dependencies and inflation factors

PROJECT ARCHIVES

PROJECT CLOSEOUT

- Lessons Learned Conducted: 15 November 20xx
- Closeout Review Complete: 20 November 20xx